

## **5. Parking permits**

If you don't have off-street or secure parking as part of the property, make sure you have the street parking for your needs. Generally, councils have exempted owners of apartments built after a particular period from obtaining parking permits, to reduce the crush on residential streets and protect the parking rights of existing owners in long-established properties.

I have encountered many first-time buyers who haven't checked this, and who live on a hope and prayer that they won't get a parking fine for their vehicle, left outside home, while they're at work. (They always do, and horribly often.) If a new apartment development doesn't have a car space included with your intended purchase, and you need parking, you absolutely must approach the council, before committing, to find out if you can obtain street permits – and most likely the answer is no.